

MIKE WAITINDI

Web Developer & Frontend Engineer

Nairobi, Kenya • Remote

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Portfolio: mikeships.vercel.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Web developer focused on turning designs and requirements into reliable, accessible, responsive production interfaces. Shipped live products include a mobile-first tourism trip planner (KenyaTrace) and an e-commerce storefront (GiGi Energy Drink). Builds and maintains full frontend systems in React, TypeScript and Tailwind against typed backend APIs, with end-to-end tests and Git-to-Vercel deployment. A background in UX research and design means requirements are read accurately, designers get a collaborator who speaks their language, and handoff ambiguity is designed out.

ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

Built and shipped KenyaTrace (kenyatrace.vercel.app), a live mobile-first tourism planner for 3G conditions - list-first architecture, client-side route-builder state, progressive loading, and every planning task verified usable at a 360px viewport.

Rebuilt the GiGi Energy Drink storefront (gigiflavours.vercel.app): merged checkout from 4 steps to 3, lifted text contrast from 2.1:1 to WCAG AA across the brand palette, and ordered payment options M-Pesa first to match real purchase behavior.

Engineered this portfolio end-to-end: React + TypeScript application with typed Convex backend functions powering the contact form and Paystack donations, verified server-side before confirming success.

Quality practice in daily use: Playwright end-to-end suite covering routes, CTAs, dialogs, form validation and the 404 path; tsc typecheck gates; Prettier formatting; fixes traced to root cause in browser DevTools rather than patched symptoms.

Delivery workflow: feature branches and reviewed pull requests in Git/GitHub, automatic deployment to Vercel on merge, canonical URLs and per-route metadata kept healthy.

EXPERIENCE & DESIGN BACKGROUND

L'ed end-to-end UI/UX design for e-commerce, tourism and banking platforms, including youth-focused mobile banking concepts validated in moderated testing.

Conducted user research, stakeholder interviews, competitive analysis and usability testing to ground interface decisions in evidence.

Built scalable design systems - tokens, typography scales, reusable component libraries - documented with states and edge cases for developer handoff.

Created wireframes, user flows and high-fidelity prototypes in Figma with build-ready specs, reducing back-and-forth during implementation.

Collaborated across business, technology and creative stakeholders to scope, estimate and prioritize features on tight deadlines.

KEY SKILLS

Frontend - JavaScript/ES6+, TypeScript, React, Next.js, semantic HTML, CSS/Tailwind, responsive layouts.

Quality & testing - Playwright e2e, accessibility (WCAG AA contrast, keyboard/focus states), form validation, loading/error/empty states, cross-browser and viewport testing.

Systems & data - component architecture, design tokens, state modeling (hooks/context), REST-style API integration, typed data contracts.

Delivery - Git/GitHub, code review via pull requests, Vercel deployment, browser DevTools debugging, performance basics (image pipelines, lazy loading).

Design & research - Figma, FigJam/Miro, wireframing, prototyping, information architecture, usability testing.

Tools - GA4, Jira. Languages - English (fluent), Kiswahili (fluent).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology South Eastern Kenya University (SEKU), Kitui, Kenya (2015-2020)